

## ADVERTORIAL

Surveillance Programme (IDSP) teams with support from respective state governments, started contact tracing for all the index patients. Rapid Response Teams (RRTs) have been formed to contain the spread of the virus in most of the states. Surge capacities of earmarked hospitals in major towns have been increased as part of medical preparedness. A wide spread campaign via electronic and press media is being carried out by MoH & FW, for awareness to the community. The antiviral drug, Oseltamivir (TamiFlu) is adequately stockpiled and prescribed only via government channels to avert development of antiviral resistance. Action has also been initiated by Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) for preparing possible vaccine against this virus.

A review of preparedness measures for business continuity in non-health related issues during a pandemic was carried out by generating guidelines on the subject by NDMA on 19th May 2009. This was followed by a high level meeting on 1st June 2009 which was attended by 60 senior government officials invited from central government, all states and union territories along with representatives from FICCI and CII at NDMA Bhawan, New Delhi. Various directions related to pandemic preparedness in health and beyond health sectors were deliberated upon in this meeting.

Preparedness activity and response are being reviewed at regular intervals by Government of India through Crisis Management Group and Inter Ministerial Task Force. A Joint

Monitoring Group, set up by MoH & FW along with member of the NDMA and WHO experts, is reviewing the preparedness and response on regular basis. This group also deliberates on various strategies that may be required to manage the pandemic.

Despite all these measures a possibility of outbreak in certain population clusters cannot be undermined, causing serious ramifications for health and non-health sectors. An active involvement of community in practicing respiratory and hand hygiene along with voluntary reporting to the medical authorities shall prove helpful in such outbreaks.

The picture of the pandemic is still evolving at global as well as national level which is the biggest testimonial to strengthen and consolidate our preparedness and response measures in both health as well as non-health sectors. All government agencies with the help of the NDMA have acted promptly, so far, to contain the magnitude of this problem. This effort has to continue at the same tempo, keeping in view the possibility of mutation of this virus and the associated dynamics.

